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ICE NEWSROOM

FEBRUARY 16, 2026 • SAVANNAH, GA • ENFORCEMENT AND REMOVAL

## Deadly evasion: Illegal immigrant flees ICE, crashes car and kills innocent driver

*The illegal alien is charged with homicide; this dangerous evasion comes after sanctuary politicians held webinars and provided resources and tips on how to openly defy ICE*

 **Oscar Vasquez Lopez**

Oscar Vasquez Lopez

**SAVANNAH, Ga.** — After months of sanctuary politicians encouraging and instructing illegal aliens to resist and evade federal law enforcement, a criminal illegal alien attempting to flee from ICE law enforcement struck and killed a motorist in Savannah.

On Feb. 16, ICE law enforcement officers attempted to apprehend Oscar Vasquez Lopez, a criminal illegal alien from Guatemala who was issued a final order of removal by a federal judge in 2024. He entered the U.S. illegally on an unknown date and at an unknown location.

During the operation, officers observed Vasquez Lopez enter a vehicle and attempted a traffic stop. Vasquez Lopez initially complied but then fled the scene, making a reckless U-turn and running a red light, colliding into a civilian vehicle. **The civilian driver sustained fatal injuries and was pronounced deceased at the scene.** Vasquez Lopez is in custody at the hospital with minor injuries and is being charged by the Chatham County Police Department with **vehicular homicide.**

“This vehicular homicide is an absolute tragedy and deadly consequence of politicians and the media constantly demonizing ICE officers and encouraging those here illegally to resist arrest — a felony,” said **Homeland Security Assistant Secretary Tricia McLaughlin**. “These dangerous tactics are putting people’s lives at risk. Fleeing from and resisting federal law enforcement is not only a crime but extraordinarily dangerous and puts oneself, our officers and innocent civilians at risk. Now, an innocent bystander has lost their life.”

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This dangerous attempt to evade arrest comes after sanctuary politicians held webinars and provided resources and tips for how to openly defy ICE:

- Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez [hosted](#) a webinar in February providing tips for illegal aliens to evade arrests at homes, workplaces or in public.
- Dan Goldman posted a [video](#) online calling on illegal aliens to make a plan for ICE encounters.
- Los Angeles Mayor Karen Bass [issued](#) multilingual flyers and online resources advising illegal aliens on how to evade arrest.
- California Governor Gavin Newsom [released](#) guides and sanctuary laws advising illegal aliens how to recognize ICE, block entry and defy arrest.

We are once again calling on sanctuary politicians, agitators, and the media to turn the temperature down and stop calling for violence and resistance against ICE law enforcement.

ICE remains committed to protecting public safety by removing dangerous illegal aliens from the country. For more information on ICE’s enforcement actions, follow us on X at [@ICEgov](#).

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